



10-26-2021 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=75OJXLJ7-K4
Publication Date	2021-10-27T09:50:01Z
Target Category	mcs

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Community Meeting Summary Report

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The presiding officer called the meeting to order, conducting roll call and leading ceremonial openings.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Dr. O'Neal, Mr. Heater, Mrs. Bales, Mr. Irvin, Mr. Lowe. (Note: Mrs. Barnes Griffin was also noted on the roll call list).
 - **Absent:** None explicitly noted.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Identified as the board president/chair.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Approval of Minutes:** Prior meeting minutes and fundraising documents were reviewed, noting corrections regarding Mr. Basham's representation of the Rotary Club and a spelling correction for girls' basketball. Approved by Voice Vote.

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:04:44 Student Advisory Committee Presentation**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Student Advisory Board members (Amaya Kate, Alicia, Sophia Brandt, Nora Cork, Logan Grady, Josie Sadler) accompanied by faculty advisor.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Students presented updates on their mission to give students a voice in the school community. They highlighted new meeting times (Fridays during advisory, 9:35 AM - 10:05 AM in Room 428) and key topics being explored: switching to a Latin honors system, student-led dress code reform, school grounds beautification, lunch period/food line efficiency, and acquiring an AP counselor. Board members challenged the students to expand their advocacy to cover all Muncie Community Schools (MCS) rather than just Central High School.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; no formal board action required.
- **00:18:07 Superintendent's Report & Updates**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. Lee Ann Kwiatkowski, Superintendent.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Dr. Kwiatkowski reported on the "canned" meetings with the George and Francis Ball Foundation regarding the cradle-to-career initiative. She announced a \$425,000 grant from the Ball Brothers Foundation directed toward athletics, academic innovation, marketing, camp adventure, COVID relief, and Career and Technical Education (CTE), bringing total competitive/foundation grant funding to over \$8 million. Additionally, Westview Elementary received the 2021 IFLTA Wide World Award for its dual language immersion program.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report; accepted.
- **00:36:51 Introduction of Southside Middle School Principal**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board President / Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Introduction of Mr. Mike Raiders as the new principal of Southside Middle School. Mr. Raiders shared his background in education, consulting, and higher education administration (Wabash College), emphasizing positive relationships and student-centered decision-making.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational introduction.
- **00:41:43 Financial Report**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Jerome, Chief Financial Officer.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Reported the receipt of the \$3.3 million state basic grant. Enrollment stands at approximately 4,925 students (up 164 since February and 117 since last September). The district maintains over \$30 million in the bank, over \$9 million in rainy day funds, and continues to pay \$50,000 monthly on its common school loan, remaining on target for a positive cash position at year-end.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:43:31 Permission to Fund Project Over \$50,000 (Grissom Elementary Playground)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Jerome.

- **Deliberation Summary:** Request to approve a project for special needs playground equipment at Grissom Elementary with commercial recreation vendors. Funding sources include a Community Foundation grant (\$59,000+), ESSER III (\$42,988), and a special education grant (\$150,000).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:21:06 Chris Hyatt**
 - Addressed the board regarding a formal public access complaint filed against Mr. Williams, questioning legal expenses and outside counsel responses. Criticized House Enrolled Act 1315, questioned local governance structures, and advised parents regarding school choice, mask mandates, and potential COVID-19 vaccination mandates.
 - **00:24:16 Chris Hines**
 - Parent of children in MCS. Addressed concerns regarding mask mandates, citing issues with soiled/dirty masks on children and requesting clear scientific evidence/guidelines used for mask policies. Inquired about whether Critical Race Theory (CRT) is taught in schools. *(Board leadership and Dr. Kwiatkowski responded directly, clarifying that CRT is not part of the curriculum, noting consultation with local health officials Dr. Byrd and Dr. Voss regarding masks, and discussing overall learning loss).*
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Mention of upcoming facility renovations at East Washington Academy (EWA).
 - Coordination offered by staff (Andy) for Ball State University journalism students seeking interviews regarding the YMCA project and the Grissom special needs playground.
 - **Adjournment:** Official motion to adjourn made and carried. Meeting adjourned.
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